Milo de Vries

Wütoschingen, Germany | +31 6 3976 5259 | milo@xdh.nl | LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/milod

Professional Statement

Over the last decade I've gone from founding and scaling a climate-tech startup to shaping product strategy at South Pole, using code, data and design to turn ideas into tools that people actually want to use. Skilled at going deep on user problems, translating technical complexity into clean product thinking, and shipping SaaS and data-driven platforms with care. Driven by craft, curiosity and building things that hold up.

Core Competencies

Product Strategy & Roadmapping • SaaS & B2B Platforms • Data & Analytics Tools • User Research / UX Collaboration • AI/ML Integrations • Agile / Lean Product Development • ClimateTech Solutions • Market Analysis • Team Leadership & Mentorship • Fundraising & Investor Relations

Technical Skills

Data & Analytics (SQL, BI tools) • SaaS Architecture & Integrations (REST/GraphQL APIs) • Cloud & DevOps (AWS, GCP, Terraform) • Python • JS/TS • Security & Identity Management (IAM) • ML / AI Integrations

Professional Experience

Product Lead — South Pole BV, Amsterdam (Apr 2022 – Present)

South Pole helps organisations realise deep decarbonisation pathways across industries.

Scope & Responsibilities

- Directed product and technical strategy across multiple SaaS initiatives spun out of the Accelerator (Climate Risk Tool, CSRD Gap Tool), taking them from ideation through PoC, MVP and scale.
- Led the technical side of the SME->Enterprise Climate Solution: drove architecture, UX design, and user testing. Contributing to market analysis, product strategy, design and evaluation of AI integrations.
- Conceived an offensive PR effort to restore South Pole's reputation in nature based offsetting. For this devised and scoped an open-source forest-impact calculator using satellite imagery and ML
- Co-developed an AI-assisted PCF (product carbon footprinting) tool.
- Coordinated South Pole's Accelerator for six early-stage climate-tech applications, defining business cases, assessing PoCs and guiding roadmaps.

Key Achievements

- Took multiple SaaS products from concept to launch, collectively serving 30+ enterprise clients and realising seven-figure revenue within 24 months.
- Delivered the SME Climate Solution MVP in 6 months with full UX/user-testing cycles.
- Delivered a 10× performance improvement on the Climate Risk tool.
- Built and launched a no-code double-materiality-assessment tool in 4 months, reducing manual work for consultants.
- Led IAM/SSO integrations across two enterprise tools, including the first integration to go live under new security requirements.
- Architected and realised the first AI-assisted PCF prototype.

Founder & CEO — CO_2ok, Utrecht (Apr 2017 – Mar 2022)

CO_2ok enables consumers to make their shopping climate neutral

Scope & Responsibilities

- Founded and grew CO_2ok from concept to acquisition; led strategy, product, development, fundraising and team building.
- Designed and launched a seamless, often tailored, integration product for online retailers across multiple e-commerce platforms.
- Brought a second product from concept to market and made a data-driven decision to sunset it and focus on the core product.
- Developed sales and marketing strategies and oversaw onboarding and support.
- Negotiated an acquihire by South Pole.

Key Achievements

- Onboarded 50+ merchants and enabled tens of thousands of compensated transactions, making climate-neutral shopping easy for consumers.
- Built and led a multidisciplinary team of 10+, secured seed funding and partnerships.
- Personally landed first major client through a tailored evidence-based pitch.
- Created and launched a second product, grew it to 100+ users.
- Delivered a successful founder exit while ensuring continued growth of the product and team.

Earlier Roles (selected):

- Senior Systems Engineer, e-Village (2015–2016)
- Senior DevOps Engineer, Unitt (2014–2015)
- DevOps Developer, Springest (2014)
- System Engineer / Security Lieutenant, Info.nl (2007–2013)

Education

- MITx – Introduction to CS & Data Science (2016)
- Stanford – Startup Engineering (2013)
- Architecting on AWS (2014)
- Technical University Eindhoven – Computer Science / Electrical Engineering (partly completed)

Languages

Dutch (native) • English (fluent) • German (fluent)

Interests

Designing (climate-tech) startups • Adventures with my daughter Nova Skiing/snowboarding • Technology • IT security/digital privacy